

Scribe

“ Stronger than high walls is the
resilience of life itself. ”

- **Area:**

2D game, Adventure Puzzle

- **Feature:**

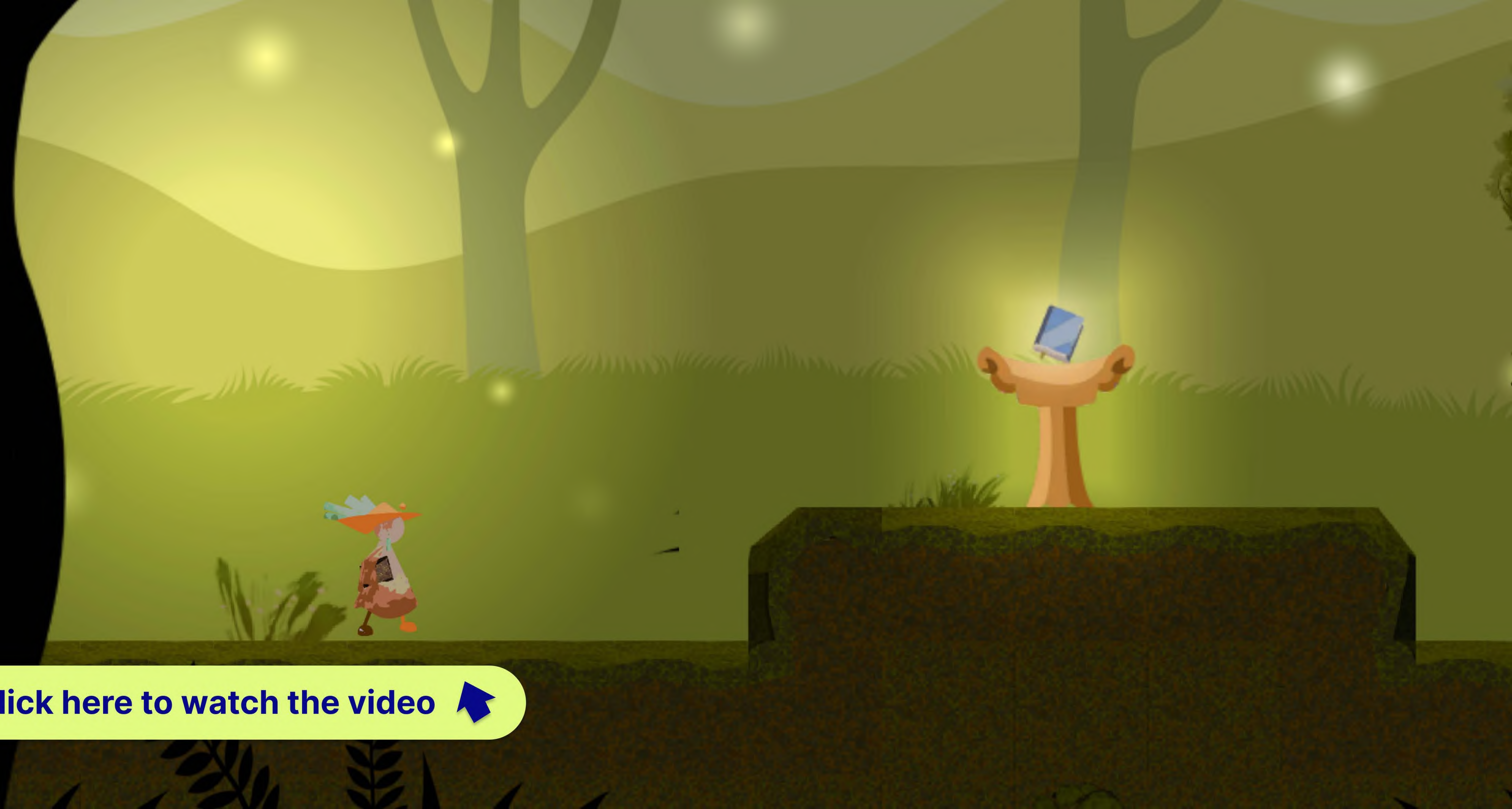
Stylized, narrative interaction

- **Duration:**

Jun.2024 - Aug.2024

- **Solo project**

[Click here to watch the video](#) 



Inspiration

Movie Plot

The protagonist's refuge is in the process of building walls to defend against the war

A monk arrives, mentoring the protagonist to begin working on the Book of Kells

To complete this immensely important manuscript, the protagonist receives the help of a forest spirit and forms a friendship

Eventually, the war arrives, and the protagonist, along with the monk, escapes with the book

The escape sequence occupies only a brief portion of the film and is not explored in great detail

One of my favorite films is **The Secret of Kells**. The movie tells the story of a tribe that survives within a constantly expanding, fortified refuge, simultaneously guarding against enemy attacks while creating the Book of Kells, a masterpiece of Celtic art and scripture, even as war confines them within the safety of their high walls

I have always wanted to base a project on this escape narrative, using a game format to explore more possibilities within the story. By leveraging the unique interactive nature of games, I aim to reconstruct and express the culture of the Book of Kells, offering players an opportunity to experience the journey of a unique civilization

World Background

In an alternate world, the relationships between civilizations are not yet tightly interconnected. People live and develop independently within their own territories. One unique civilization can hear the voices of nature and exists in harmony with all living things. After thousands of years of development, they built their civilization within the forest, creating magnificent architecture. They cherish painting, recording, and reflection, leaving behind vast amounts of books and artworks. However, unexpectedly, this civilization was destroyed in an instant. Due to an uncontrolled event, their creations—paintings and writings—transformed into a catastrophic disaster, pushing their civilization to the brink of collapse.

Game Background

Lynx is the sole survivor of this civilization. In the final moments, carrying the most important relic of their people—a book documenting the history of their civilization—Lynx hastily escaped the catastrophe. Determined to continue the journey of their people, Lynx sets out to complete the story of the civilization, documenting its history and ensuring the legacy of their people is shared with the world, so the civilization can endure. Players will control Lynx as they explore four distinct stages of the civilization's story: Discovery, Establishment, Prosperity, and the Collapse. They will experience the rise and fall of this once-great civilization.

Years later, with the war now over, the protagonist returns to the former refuge, bringing with him the book and the dawn of peace

Animism

The Celts held a belief known as Animism, which posited that all things possess a soul or spirit. In this worldview, not only humans but also animals, plants, rivers, mountains, and even inanimate objects were believed to have independent souls and consciousness.

Ogham Script

Ogham is an ancient Celtic writing system. Named after trees, it represents the meaning of trees. It was carved into stones, sticks, wooden posts, and trees. Used in oral traditions, it served as a means of transmitting secret messages and codes. Ogham symbols marked graves, borders, and, in Ireland, over 300 stones bear Ogham inscriptions. Druids would use it for rituals or to record significant events.

Ogham Script

Symbolic Patterns

Dara Celtic Knot: A famous Celtic symbol, typically portrayed with intertwined lines, representing the roots of the ancient oak tree. Like other Celtic knots, the Dara Knot consists of continuous lines with no beginning or end, symbolizing eternity.

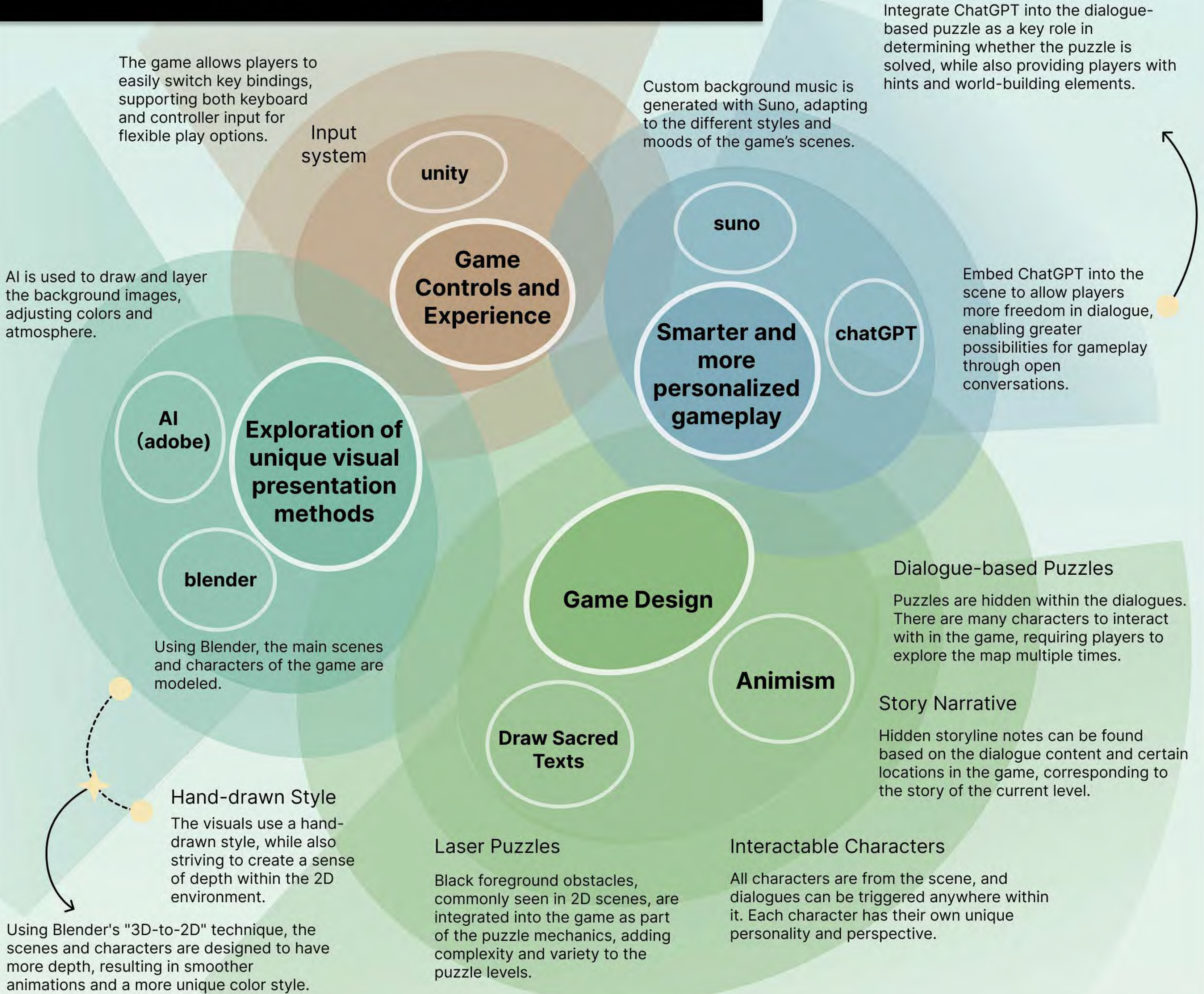
Symbolic Patterns

Celtic Illuminated Manuscripts

The decorative pages of Celtic manuscripts are vast and breathtaking, filled with intricate and exquisite designs. The most remarkable of these are the complex, detailed Celtic motifs. It is said that the designs were drawn by sharpening feather quills to an extremely fine point, with many details so tiny they could only be seen with a magnifying glass.

Celtic Illuminated Manuscripts

Game design



Character Design

Player/Enemy



Player

Character Name: Lynx

The lynx is often regarded as a symbol of wisdom, mystery, and independence. Naming the character "Lynx" conveys traits of agility, intelligence, and a deep connection with nature.

Character Design

The character carries a scripture in their right hand and wears a hat with a green feather. A small orb floats above the hat, and green earrings adorn their ears. Their feet are in mismatched socks and shoes, and they are dressed in a long robe that covers most of their body.

Background Story

The sole survivor of a sudden disaster, they possess unwavering courage and the books used for drawing. They are rewriting the history of civilization and serve as the hope for passing on its legacy.

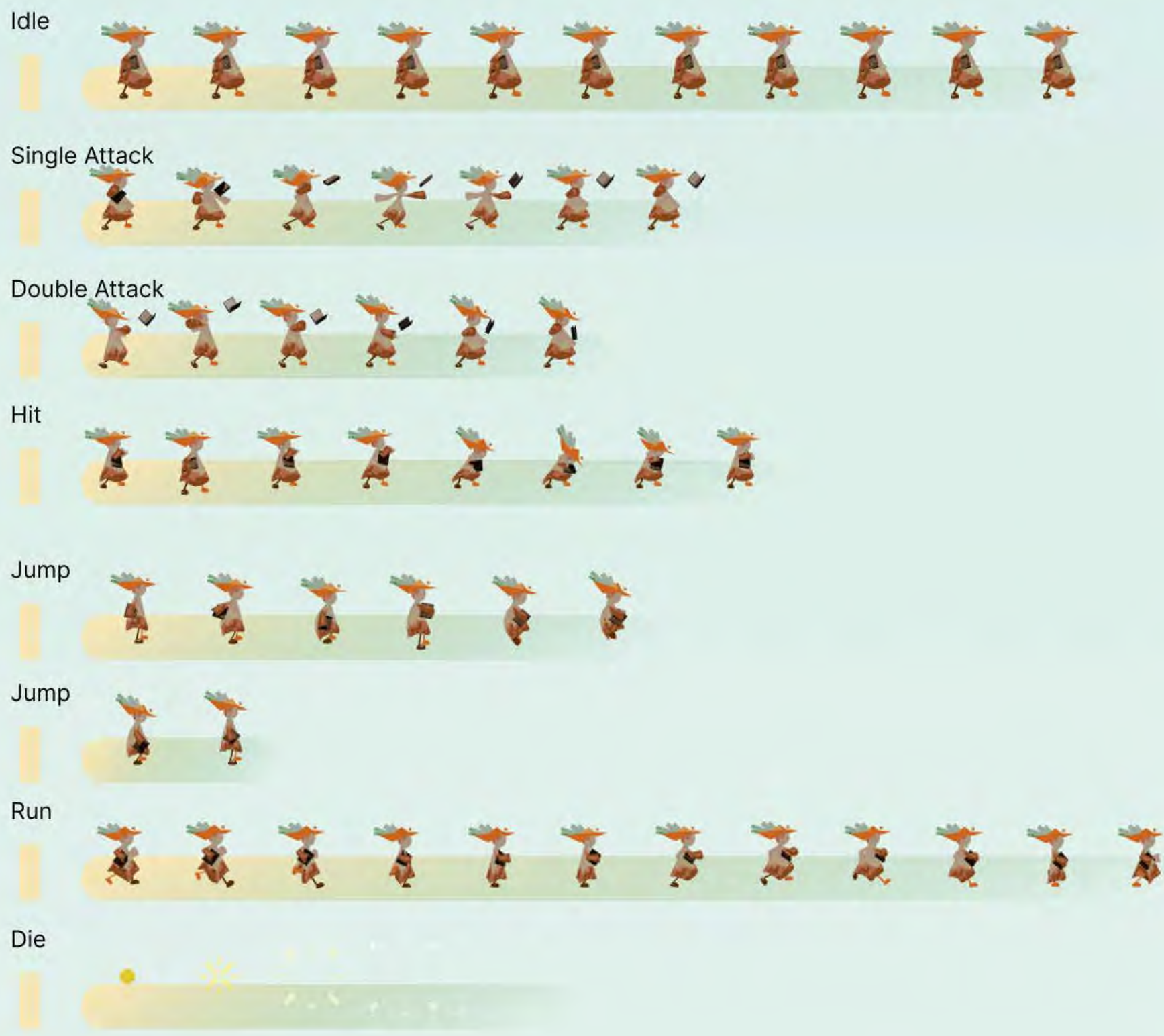
Keyboard Controller Actions

W	A Button	Jump
A	D-Pad Left	Run Left
D	D-Pad Right	Run Right
E	X Button	View Text/ Dialogue/Save
L	Start	Load Save
Space	RT	First Attack
Double Space	RB	Second Attack



Small Decorations

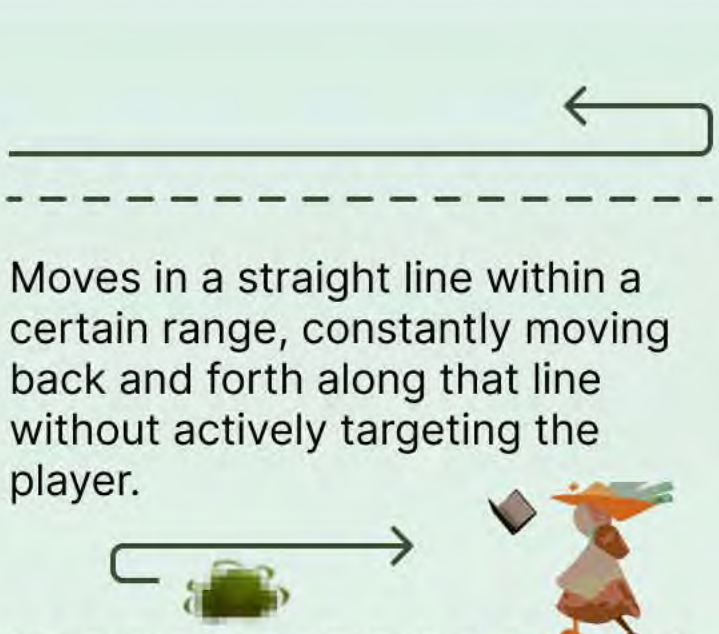
Weapons



Grass Clumps

They look no different from the harmless grass clumps in the meadow, but they move back and forth. Their behavior is easy to predict: as soon as the player touches them, they will attack.

Enemy



Cloud Masses

Similar to the grass clumps, these are hidden within clouds that blend seamlessly with the background. As soon as the player enters a certain range, they will chase and attack. Sometimes, the attack can be sudden.



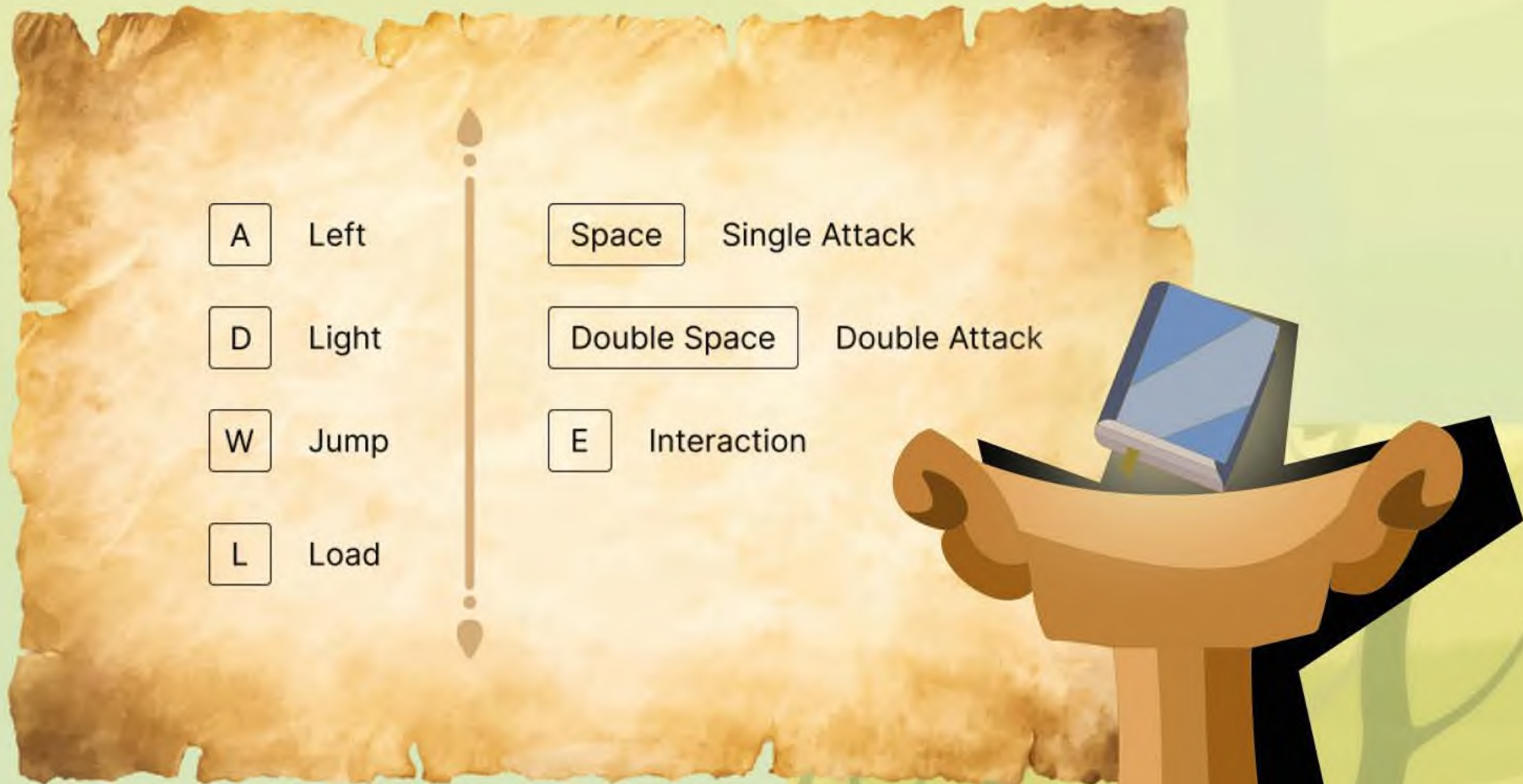
Game chapters design

4 chapters in total

Prologue

Interactive Objects

The player receives gameplay controls and prompts here



The forest where you first arrive marks both the beginning and the end of the story. With the book's instructions in hand, uncover the tale of a lost civilization.

Interactive Objects

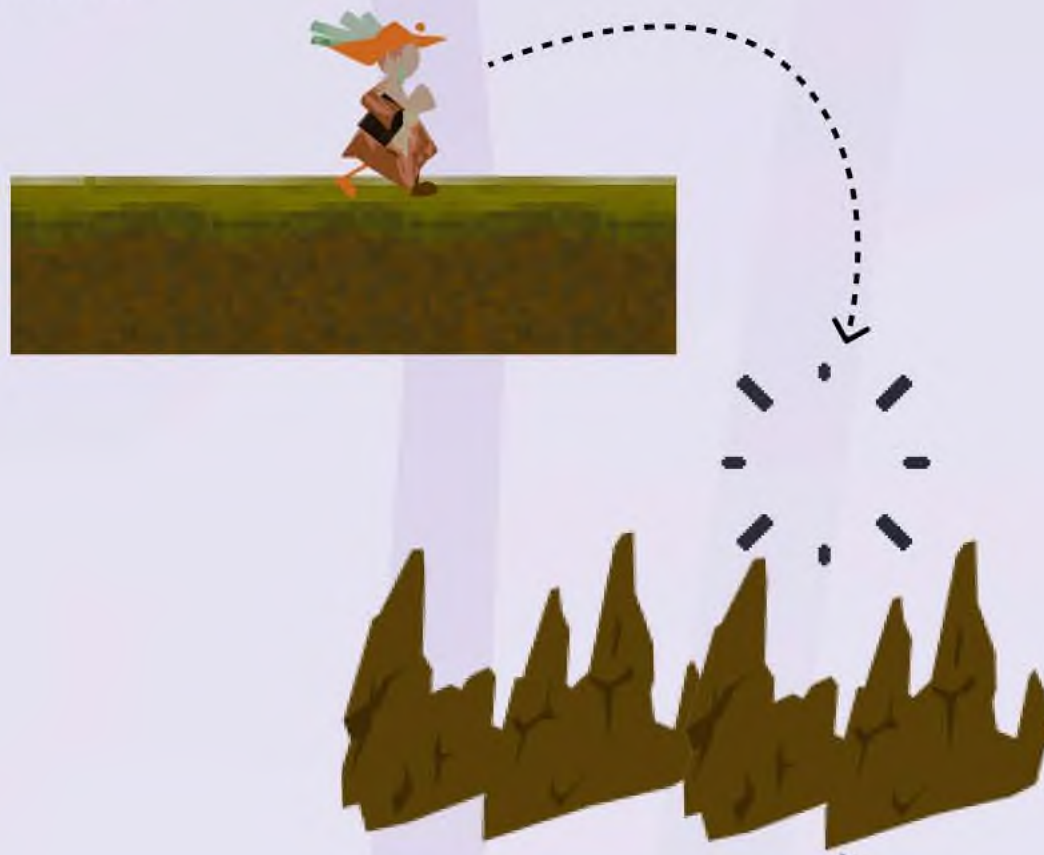


Enemies



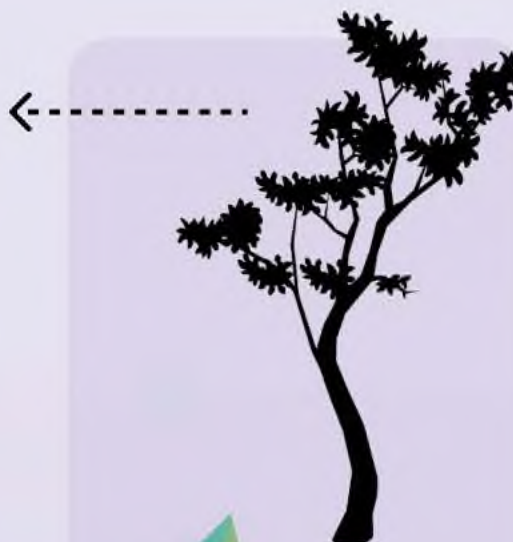
Trap: Spikes

When players jump from a platform, they may fall onto the spikes below. Contact with the spikes results in instant death.



Puzzle: Moving Platforms

Players can use the mouse to move foreground obstacles. As these obstacles shift, specific platforms in the background will move, altering the game map layout and allowing players to access more areas in the game.



Select a foreground object and move it



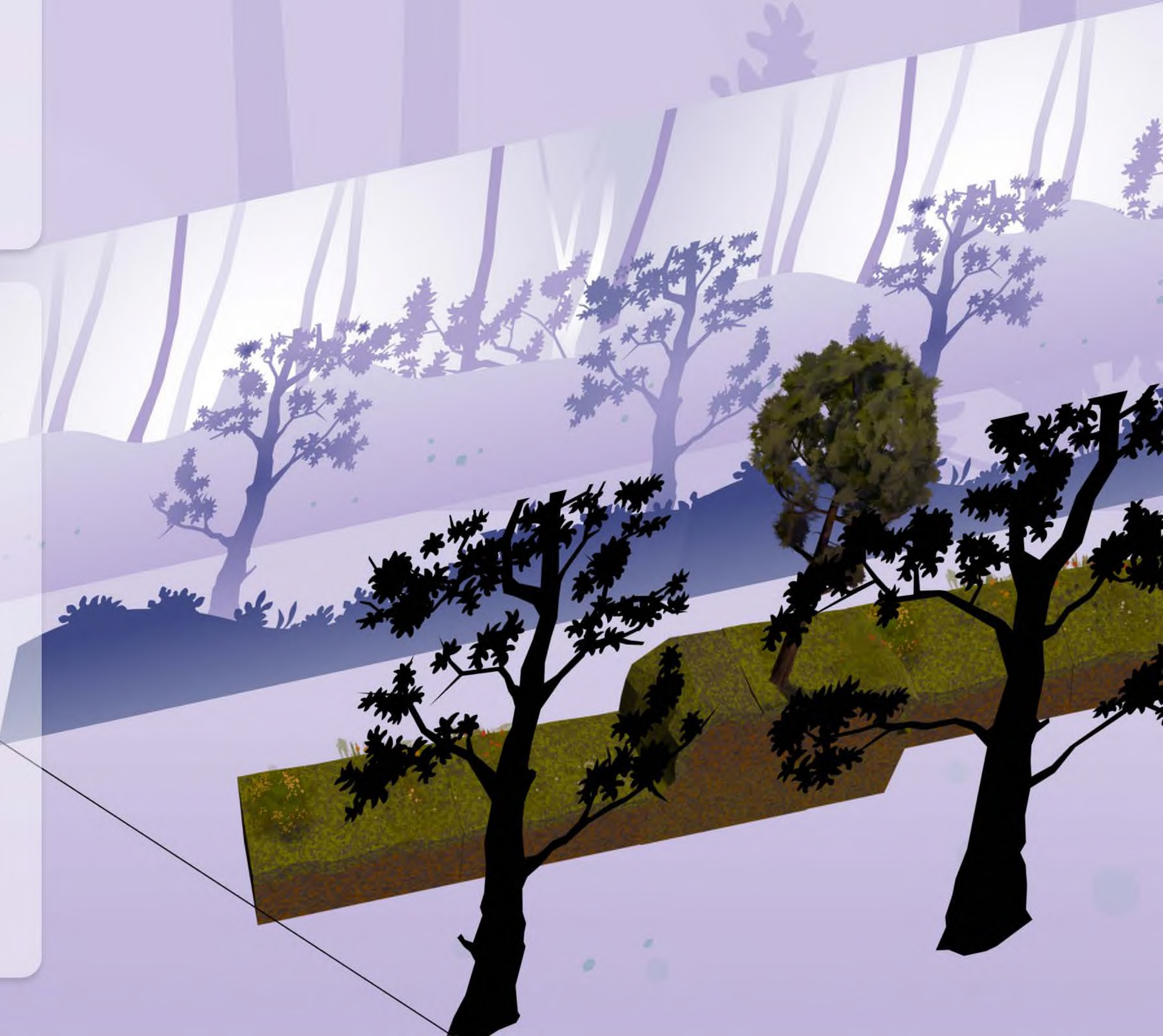
The platform in the background moves based on the foreground object



The player can follow the platform's movement to reach a new platform

Chapter One · Exploration

The forest shrouded in a dense purple mist is an uncharted world, teeming with the unknown.





A high scaffold stretches across the sky, hidden among the clouds and birds, where danger lurks in the depths of the sky—but opportunities are equally embedded within.

Interactive Objects

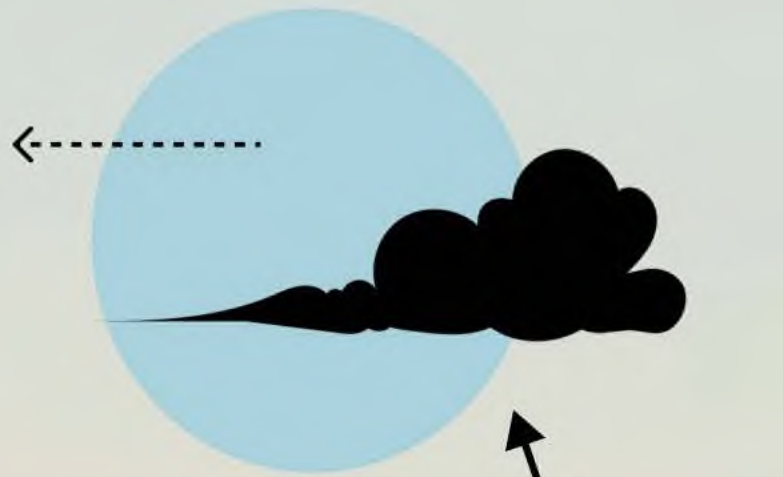


Enemies

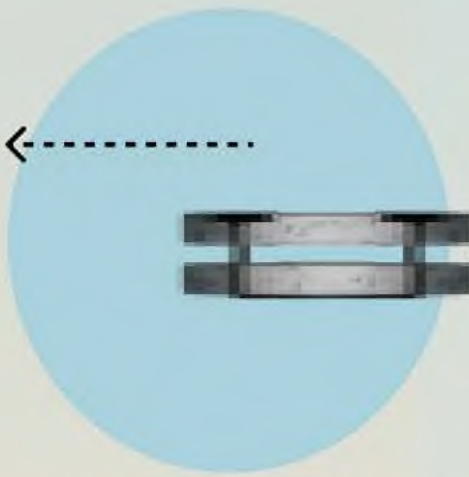


Puzzle: Lasers

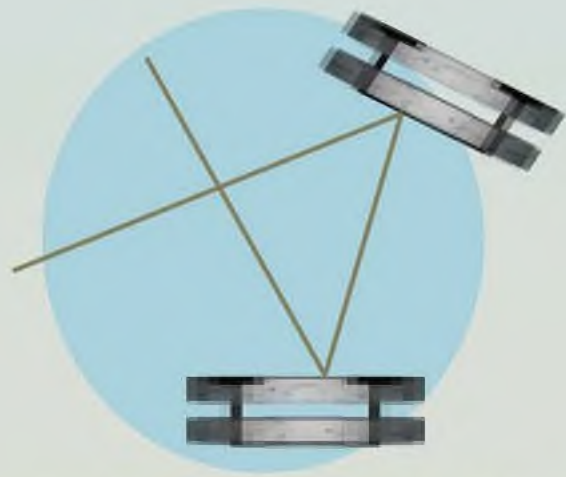
Building on the platform-moving mechanics from Chapter One, this puzzle combines platform movement with laser refraction. By adjusting the angles, players can create different refractions, enhancing the diversity and complexity of the puzzles.



Select and move foreground objects



Platforms in the background will move according to the foreground adjustments



Platforms can refract lasers, and moving them will direct the laser to different locations



Proper laser positioning can cleverly eliminate enemies



Once the laser refracts onto the corresponding platform, it will disappear, allowing players to continue exploring

Chapter Two · Establishment

Trap: Falling Boxes and High Drops

Boxes suspended in the air may fall when a player enters their vicinity. Players must dodge these boxes before being crushed. Additionally, if a player jumps and falls below all the scaffolding, they will also die.



Entering the detection range causes obstacles to fall; being struck will result in death



Falling below all the scaffolding while within the detection range will also lead to death

Chapter Three · Prosperity

Inside the magnificent palace, a reflection of its former glory. Now, only dust-covered bookshelves and shattered stone pillars remain.

Puzzle: Dialogue Puzzle

Chapter Three features five pillars. By solving the puzzle related to the fifth pillar, players can advance through Chapter Three. This puzzle requires clues from the first four pillars, prompting players to find corresponding dialogues in the first two chapters to uncover four answers.



Once the four answers are communicated to the fifth pillar, players will successfully complete Chapter Three

Chapter Four · Uncontrolled

The forest burns in flames, no longer teeming with life. The great walls collapse, and survival must be sought elsewhere.

Interactive Objects



Enemies

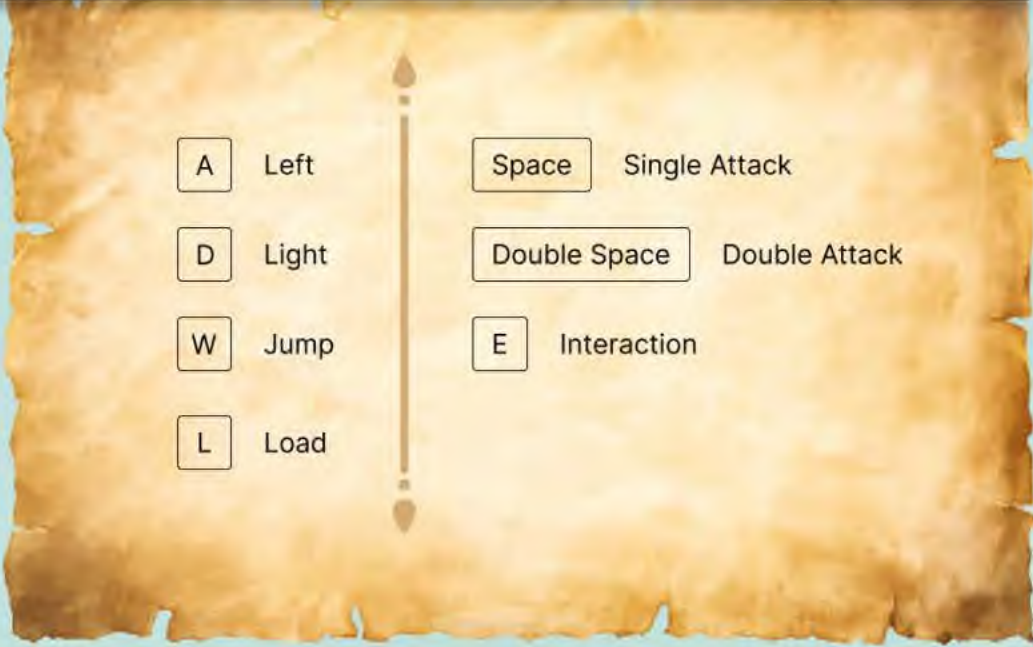


Trap and Puzzle: Chapter One + Chapter Two

Falling from platforms leads to instant death by spikes, and giant boulders may fall at any moment along the way.

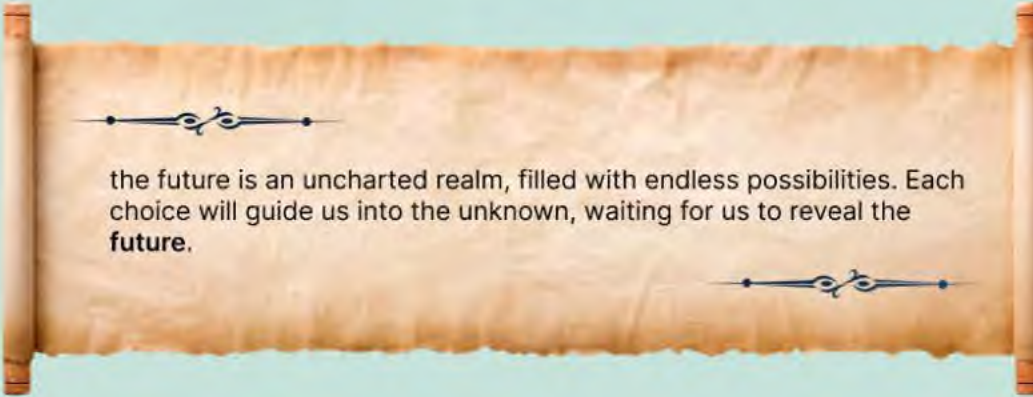


UI Art Design



Key Prompt UI

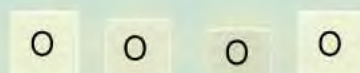
Displays key controls for movement, attack, interaction, etc., to help players easily view and understand the key mappings.



Interactive Prompts

When the player is within the interactive range, an interaction prompt will appear above their head, indicating that they can press a button to interact. Interactions may include dialogues, story events, and key prompts, among others

Keyboard Interaction Prompt

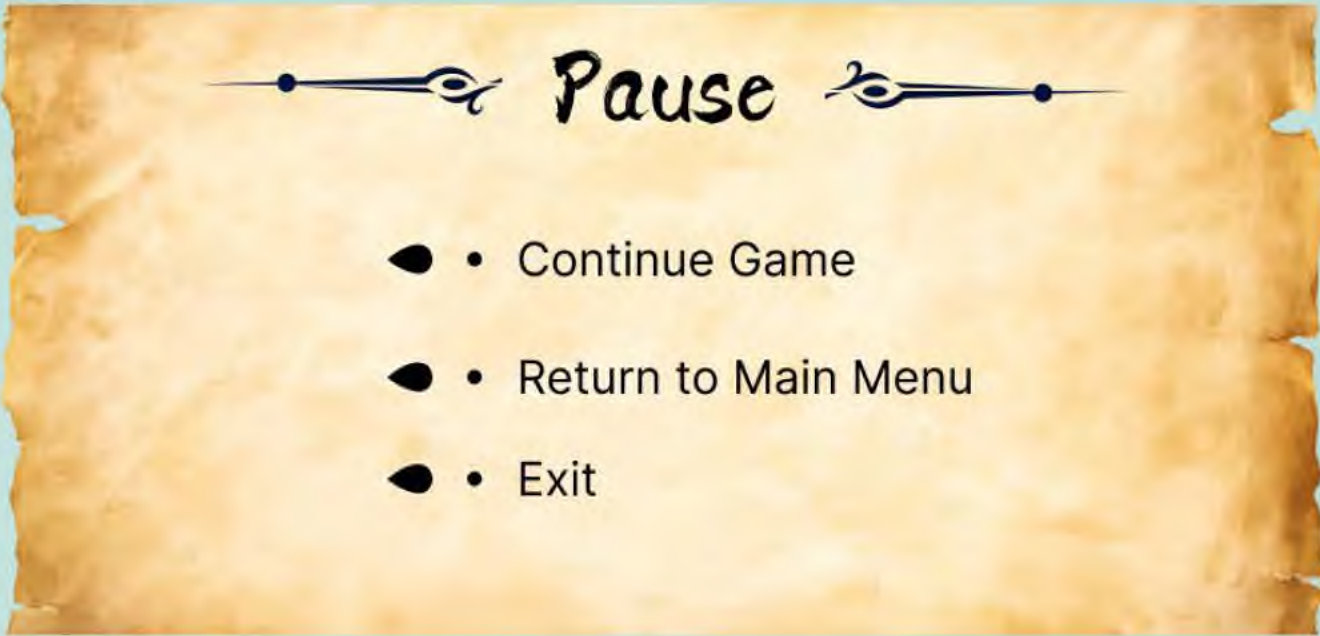


Controller Interaction Prompt



Pause Screen

When the player pauses the game, a pause menu will appear, offering options to resume the game, return to the main menu, or quit. This enhances the overall game experience



Dialogue Box

The dialogue box uses a scroll design, aligning with the overall UI style. This also hints that the game's story is one recorded on a scroll

Interactive Tablet

When the player is within an interactive range, an interaction prompt will appear above their head, indicating the button to press for interaction. Interactions include dialogues, cutscenes, and key press indicator lights



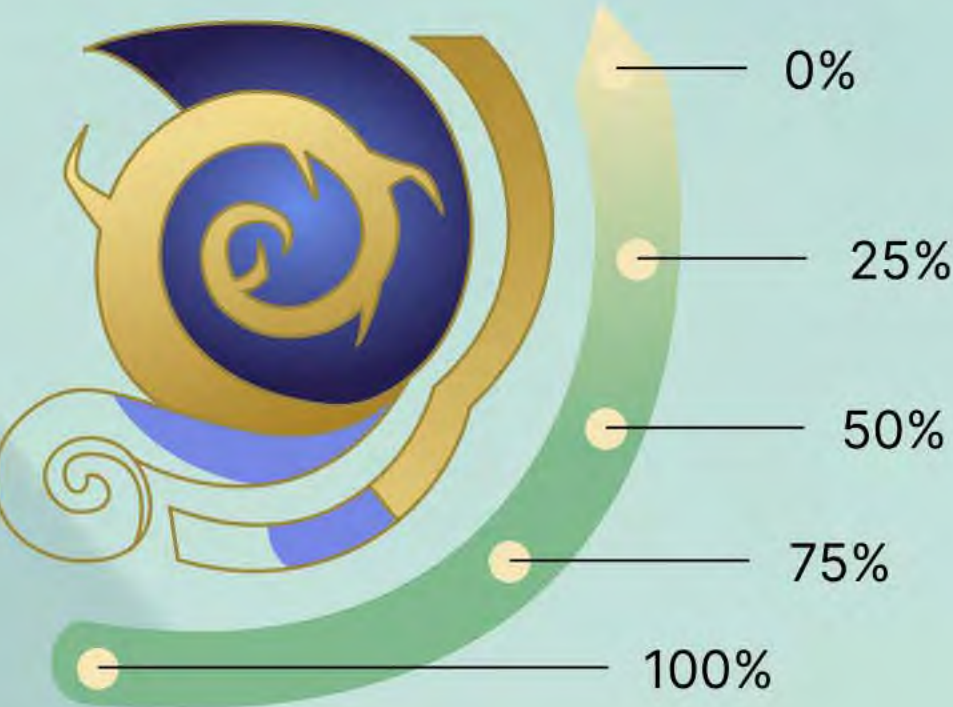
Dialogue Box

Save points are hidden within the forest, and perhaps a certain interactive tree serves as a save point. After saving, ordinary trees will turn gray, signaling to the player that the current progress has been recorded



Character Health Bar

Inspired by the Triskele symbol from Celtic culture, which is considered a symbol of good luck and protection. In Celtic tradition, it represents the cycle of life, death, and rebirth, as well as the connection between the past, present, and future



Based on Health

The health bar will gradually disappear according to the range of health (x-x), with a proportional rotation effect to show the health depletion

Health Depletion Delay Animation

After taking damage, the health will slowly decrease to the new, lower health value. The purple layer behind the health bar will disappear at a slower rate, intensifying the visual reminder of the player's health reduction

Game Music

Background music for the game's scenes is created using Suno.



Chapter One
The Tranquil Forest

Keywords : Game background music, Forest, Tranquil, Sense of exploration, Serenity



Chapter Three
Eternal Echoes

Keywords : Game background music, opulent palace, majestic, grand, relatively calm, lyricism



Chapter Two
The Azure Sky

Keywords : Game background music, vast sky, ethereal, vibrant, relaxed pace



Chapter Four
The Dark Forest

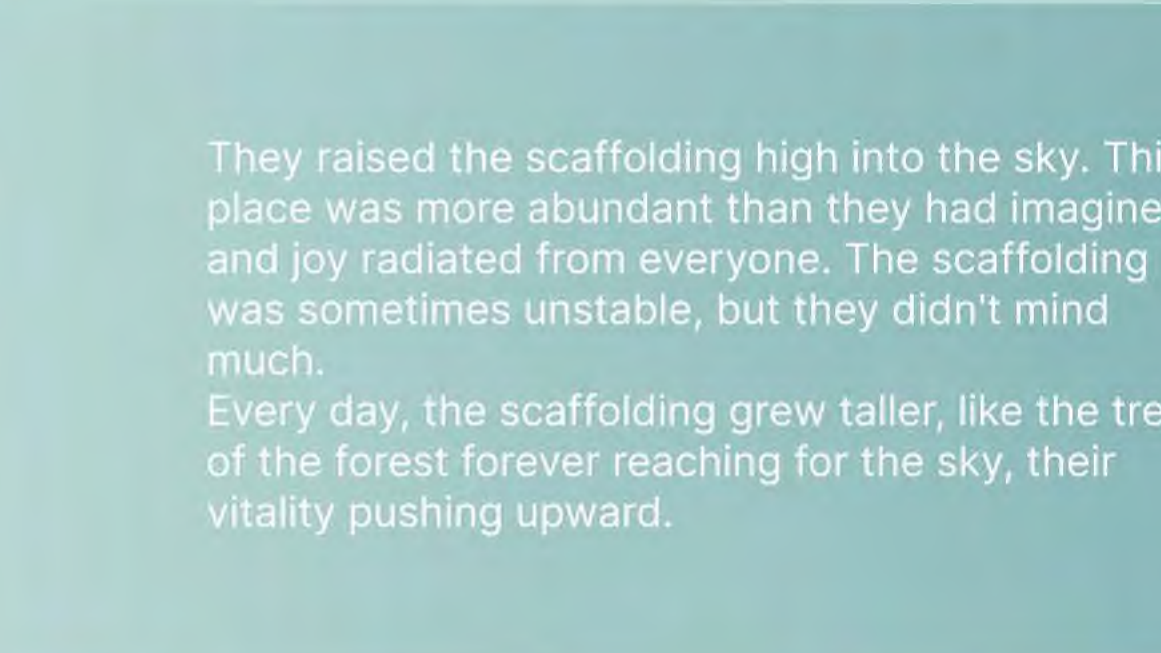
Keywords : Game background music, nordic, celtic, tense, melancholic

Game Narrative

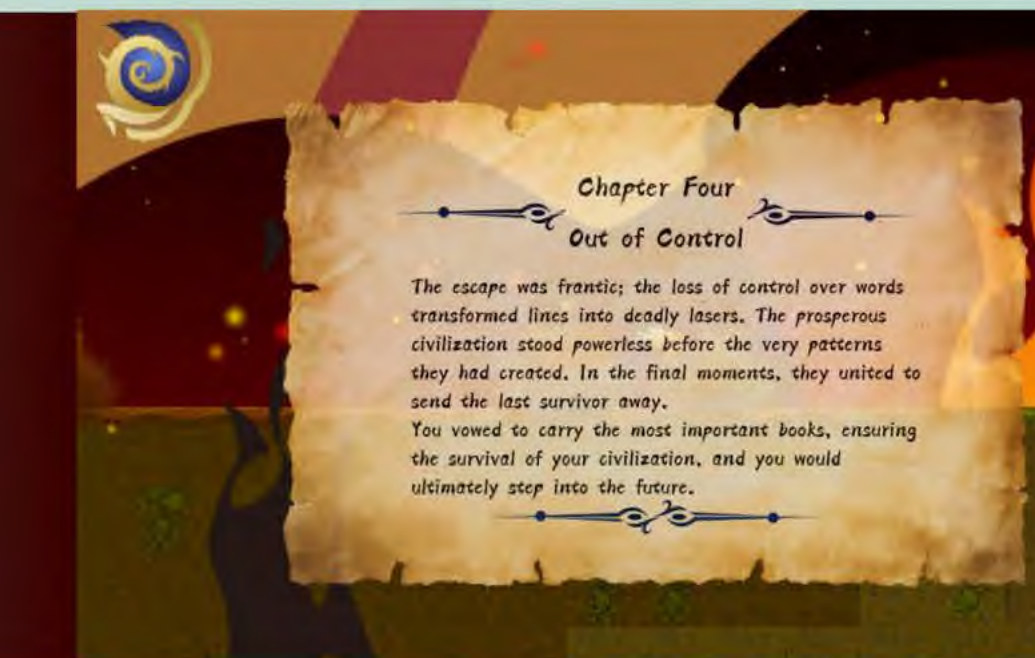
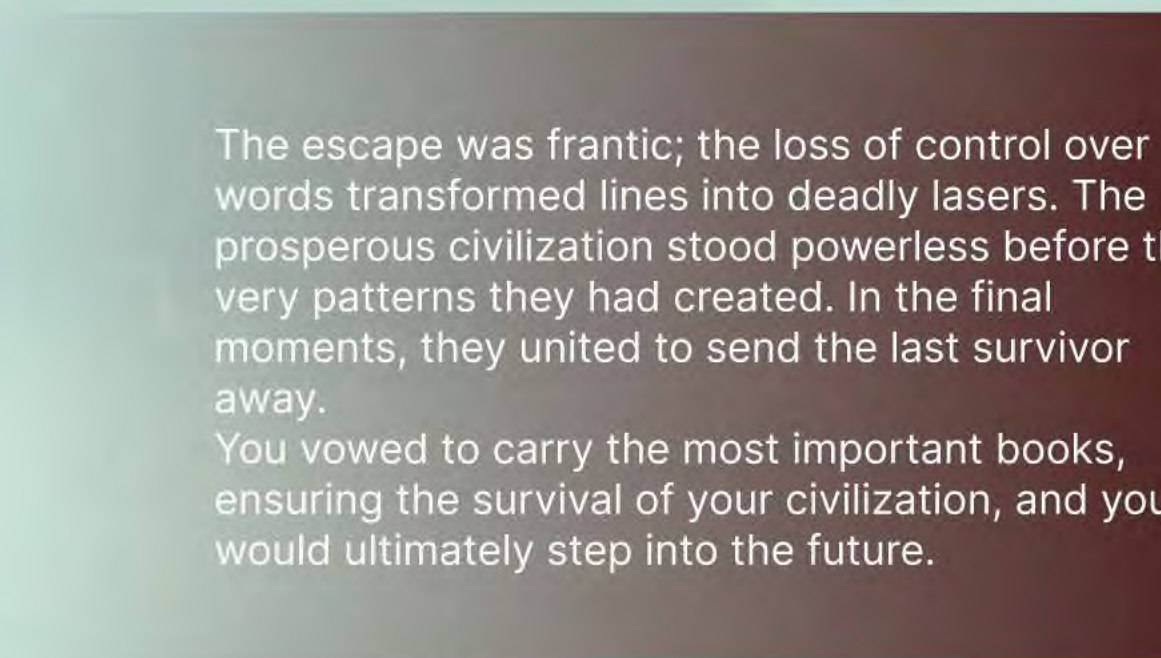
Each map in the chapters contains the storyline for that particular chapter



They arrived in the forest. It's hard to know exactly how many came at first; perhaps there were fewer than ten, or maybe an entire village. What is certain is that they heard the forest's call and chose to stay. The beginning was filled with hardships; they were unfamiliar with their surroundings, and countless challenges awaited them. Yet, they decided to trust themselves and the forest.



Within the resplendent hall, their shadows seemed small. They loved art, and naturally, they captured their experiences and distant histories in their books. The pages filled with their knowledge and records formed a grand edifice, far exceeding their physical presence. Their ambitions soared as they sought to document the entire world, including themselves; every line in their books and paintings represented another vast world.



Game Flow

Game Start Page



At the game start page, players can choose "New Game," "Continue," or "Exit."

Prologue



At the beginning of the game, the player appears in a forest. On a platform in front of them, there is a Book of Illustrations. Opening it will display the character controls.



On the far-right side of the starting page, there's a cave. Follow the prompts and press E to enter the cave and begin Chapter 1.

Chapter 1



Players can find the storyline of Chapter 1 on the map.



Players encounter the first enemy and practice attacking and dodging.



In Chapter 1, players can find some NPCs to interact with within the map.



Chapter 2

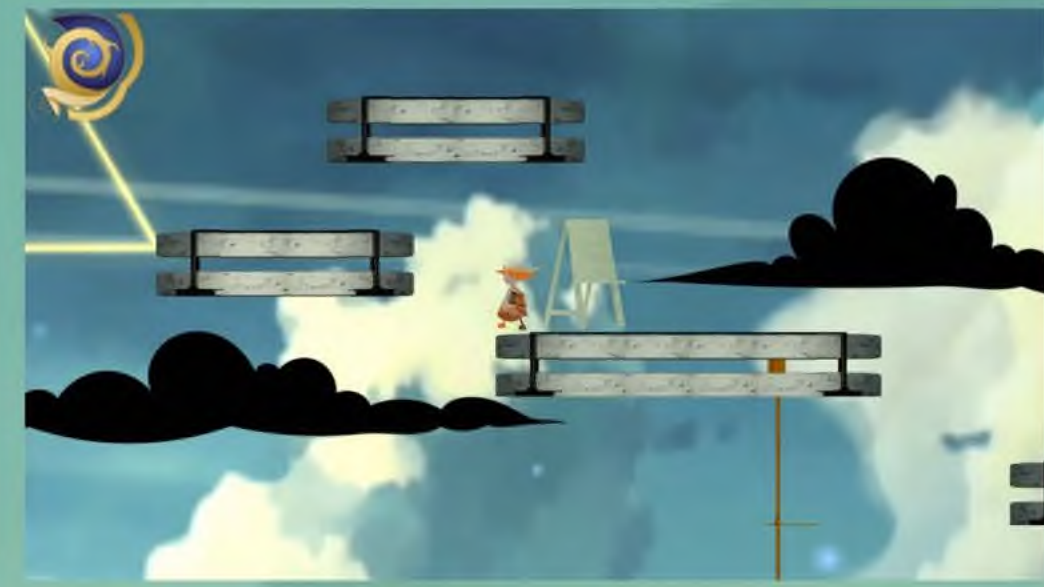
In Chapter 2, players encounter a new enemy — Clouds.



Traps will fall from above, ready to crush the player at any moment.



Players can also find the storyline of Chapter 2 on the map.



By moving foreground obstacles, players can change the movement of platforms and block the lasers, allowing them to progress.

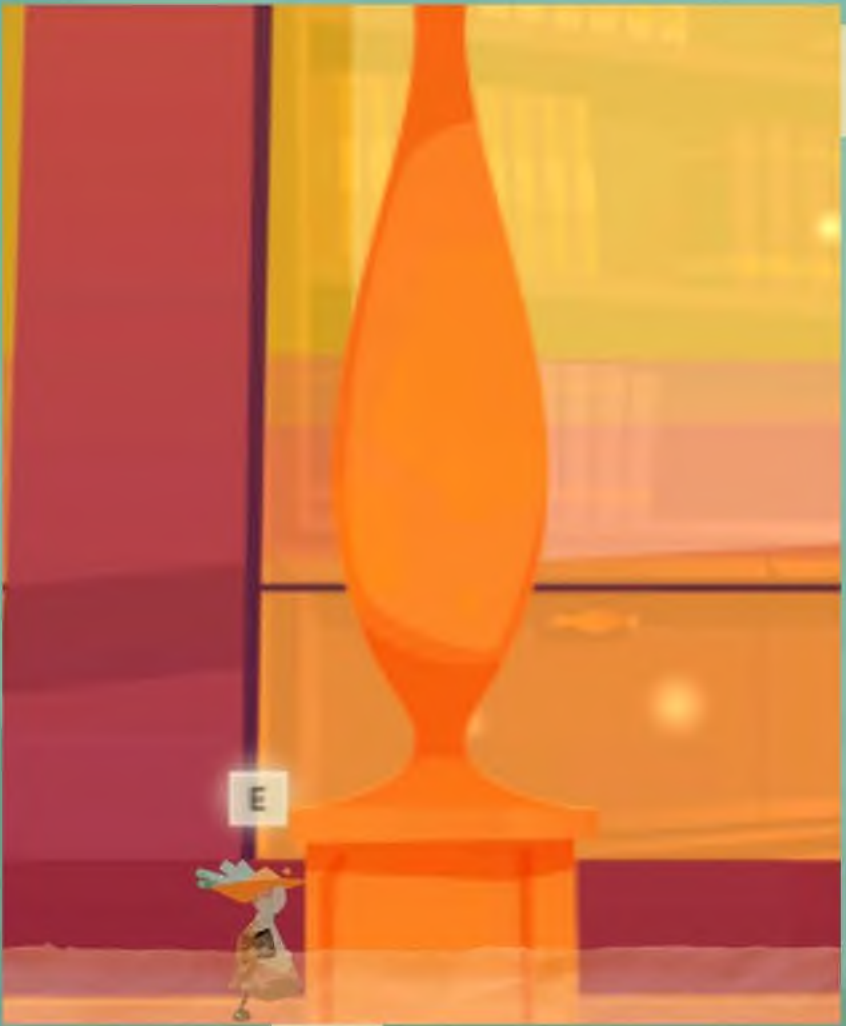
Players can also use the lasers to defeat enemies.

Chapter 4

The protagonist faces grass, cloud clusters, and multiple enemies while also dealing with the threat of lasers. Players must handle all the enemies and traps from the previous three chapters simultaneously.



Players can also find the storyline of Chapter 4 here.



Through dialogue, players solve puzzles. To uncover the answers, they need to explore the maps of the previous two chapters more deeply, gather more information, and become further immersed in the story.

Chapter 3



Players can find the storyline of Chapter 3 here.